

composer Franco Alfano. Nevertheless, conducting the opera's first performance in 1926, Toscanini movingly laid down the baton at the point at which Puccini's writing had ceased. The great composer's body now lies in an improvised chapel in his villa at Torre del Lago.

“ Don't let my **Turandot** die! ”

GIACOMO PUCCINI



PUCCINI AND HIS WIFE, ELVIRA

The composer (center) and his wife (left) are shown here in a car in Lucca. In 1903, Puccini's chauffeur swerved the car off the road; Puccini was discovered trapped beneath it, with a broken leg and almost choked to death by gasoline fumes.